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Research

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Alternative Energy

Industry

China Renewables & Utilities Sector

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Weekly #92: Solar pricing regulation, solar glass, Yangtze Power

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DB weekly comment

China's efforts to promote more orderly competition in the solar industry continue to advance. On 31 July, China's State Administration for Market Regulation (SAMR) held a pricing compliance meeting attended by 27 solar companies, urging implementation of the newly released PV cost-accounting standard, stronger pricing discipline, and tighter oversight of below-cost competition. Earlier this week, the China Photovoltaic Industry Association (CPIA) released the ***General Principles for Cost Accounting Models in the PV Industry***. The new guideline aims to improve cost transparency and provide a common reference point for pricing discussions, as policymakers and industry associations continue to address prolonged losses and excess capacity across parts of the sector. While previous initiatives aimed at curbing intense price competition have had a limited impact on industry pricing so far, the latest development represents another step in the industry's push for better pricing discipline.

Near-term solar pricing remains under pressure, with wafer prices declining by a further 3% this week despite ongoing regulatory efforts to improve pricing discipline across the industry. Our margin tracker suggests polysilicon producers remain cash loss-making, while wafer and cell manufacturers are operating around cash break-even levels.

As we highlighted earlier, **solar glass** remains one of the few segments seeing modest improvement. Despite still-lacklustre end demand, solar glass prices have risen by 2-4% since mid-July, supported by supply reductions driven by more production lines entering maintenance, which have facilitated inventory destocking. Industry inventories are still running at around 45 days as of 30 July, but have declined meaningfully from the June peak of 53 days. Xinyi Solar's (0968.HK) share price has rebounded 5% in July, outperforming solar peers by 17%. Trading at 0.6x P/B, we believe the stock offers an attractive risk-reward profile.

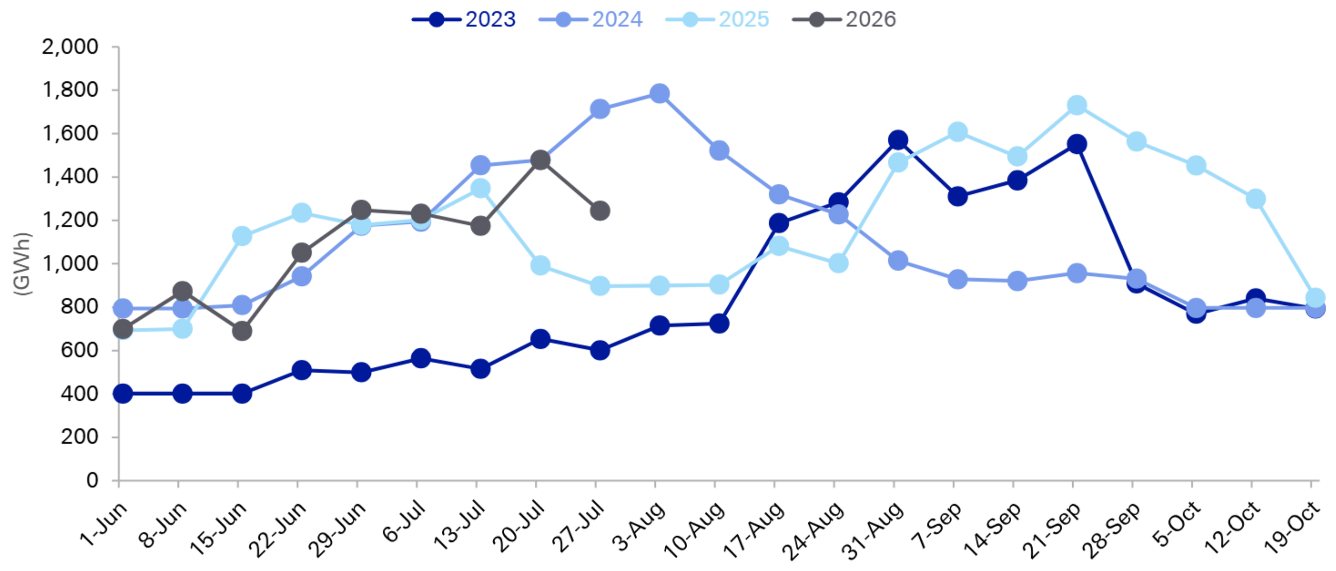
Figure 1: Solar weekly price data

Product	Unit	7/29/2026	WoW	YTD	MTD (July)
Polysilicon					
Rod Silicon	CNY/kg	32.0	0.0%	-40.6%	-3.6%
Granular silicon	CNY/kg	31.0	0.0%	-38.6%	-4.6%
Non-China polysilicon price	USD/kg	18.5	0.0%	2.8%	0.0%
Wafer					
182mm mono-Si wafer	CNY/piece	0.80	-3.6%	-42.9%	-11.1%
182*210mm mono-Si wafer	CNY/piece	0.90	-3.2%	-40.0%	-8.2%
210mm mono-Si wafer	CNY/piece	1.10	-2.7%	-35.3%	-6.8%
Cell					
182mm (M10) mono-Si cell	CNY/Watt	0.27	0.0%	-28.9%	-6.9%
182*210mm (G12R) mono-Si cell	CNY/Watt	0.26	0.0%	-31.6%	-10.3%
210mm (G12) mono-Si cell	CNY/Watt	0.27	0.0%	-30.3%	-11.7%
Module					
182mm N-type TOPCon bi-facial module	CNY/Watt	0.72	0.0%	3.2%	-2.8%
Module price for utility-scale projects	CNY/Watt	0.70	0.0%	2.2%	-2.8%
Module price for distributed solar	CNY/Watt	0.74	0.0%	4.2%	-2.0%
Solar glass					
3.2mm solar glass price	CNY/sqm	15.5	0.0%	-13.9%	1.6%
2.0mm solar glass price	CNY/sqm	8.6	0.0%	-20.5%	3.6%

Source: China Silicon Association, InfoLink, SCI99, SMM

On the utilities side, our hydro power output tracker for **China Yangtze Power (600900.SS)** points to a decent pick-up in output since late July, bringing July output growth to an estimated 16% YoY. We expect this to support an acceleration in 3Q26 output growth, versus 7% YoY in 1Q26 and 3% YoY in 2Q26. The third quarter is typically the peak season for hydropower generation, accounting for around 37% of annual output. China Yangtze Power is currently trading at a 3.7% FY26E dividend yield, representing a c.200bp premium to China's 10-year government bond yield and close to the historical high. We view its strong dividend visibility, supported by a payout ratio of over 70% and a free cash flow yield above 6%, as a key attraction amid recent market volatility.

Figure 2: China Yangtze Power - daily power output tracker (five key power stations ex. Gezhouba)



Source: Changjiang Water Resources Commission, Deutsche Bank estimates

Weekly share performance (as of 31 July 2026). By sub-sector, Solar/Gas/Renewable operators/Hydro increased by 5%/4%/2%/1% WoW, while HK Utilities/IPPs remained flat, respectively.

Recent DB reports

China Yangtze Power: Hydro momentum picked up in July; yield appeal amid market turbulence – 28 July 2026

GCL Technology: Takeaways from our LFP cathode materials factory visit – 20 July 2026

Drinda: Space business progress and industry update – 07 July 2026

China Solar Sector: Lingering at the bottom; solar glass nearing a cyclical turning point – 07 July 2026

China Gas Holdings: FY26 core earnings in line with slight dividend miss; worst likely behind – 26 June 2026

China Power Sector: Frozen solar installations; above-normal heat may lift power demand – 25 June 2026

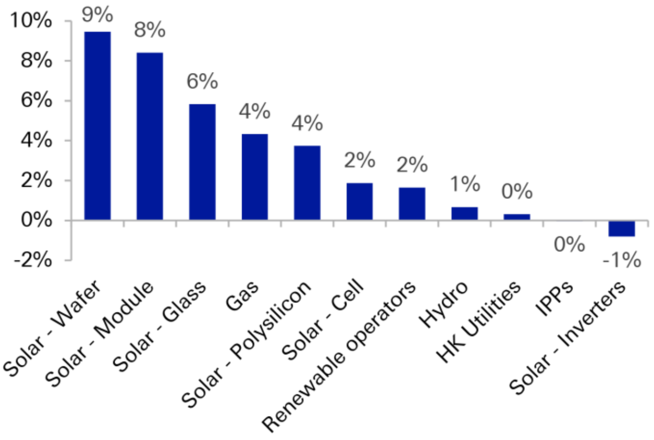
China Gas Holdings: Management share award scheme approved by independent shareholders – 24 June 2026

China City-gas Utilities: Time to revisit? – 16 June 2026

Previous issues of Weekly Digest: #73 (02 Jan 2026), #74 (08 Jan), #75 (16 Jan), #76 (23 Jan), #77 (29 Jan), #78 (05 Feb), #79 (27 Feb), #80 (06 Mar), #81 (13 Mar), #82 (27 Mar), #83 (02 Apr), #84 (10 Apr), #85 (17 Apr), #86 (24 Apr), #87 (21 May), #88 (29 May), #89 (02 July), #90 (12 July), #91 (24 July)

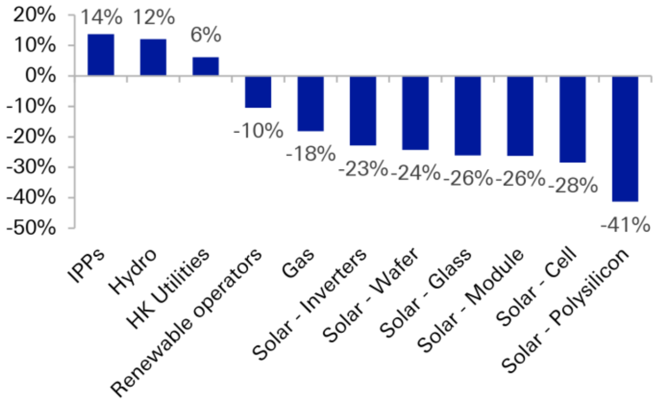
Weekly Charts

Figure 3: Weekly sub-sector share performance



Source: Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 4: YTD sub-sector share performance



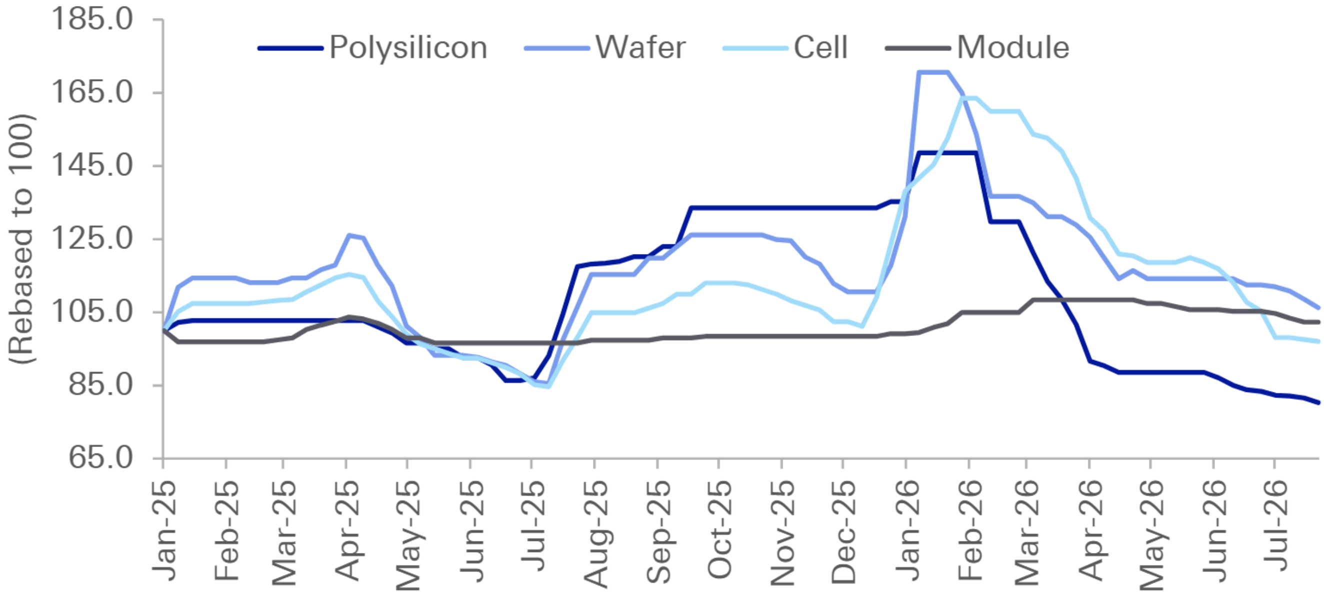
Source: Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 5: Valuation comparison

Company	BBG ticker	Market Cap (USD MN)	Rating	TP (LC)	Price (LC)	U/D	P/E (x) 2026E	P/E (x) 2027E	P/E (x) 2028E	P/B (x) 2026E	P/B (x) 2027E	P/B (x) 2028E	ROE (%) 2026E	ROE (%) 2027E	ROE (%) 2028E	Div yield (%) 2026E	Div yield (%) 2027E	Div yield (%) 2028E	EPS CAGR 2026-28E
Solar manufacturers																			
LONGi	601012 CH	14,578	Buy	25.00	12.99	92%	n.m.	126.5	35.2	1.9	1.9	1.8	-5.0	1.5	5.2	0.0	0.1	0.4	n.a.
Drinda	2865 HK	1,525	Buy	39.00	15.09	158%	n.m.	8.5	4.9	1.3	1.1	0.9	-18.5	14.4	20.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	n.a.
Xinyi Solar	968 HK	2,566	Buy	3.60	2.20	64%	86.7	14.3	8.7	0.6	0.6	0.5	-0.8	4.0	6.4	0.0	4.0	6.6	216%
GCL Tech	3800 HK	2,501	Buy	1.10	0.61	80%	n.m.	16.6	6.0	0.4	0.4	0.4	-2.2	2.3	6.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	n.a.
Tongwei	600438 CH	7,787	Sell	10.00	11.68	-14%	n.m.	n.m.	180.8	1.6	1.8	1.8	-18.8	-9.8	1.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	n.a.
Clean energy operators																			
China Yangtze Power	600900 CH	105,411	Buy	36.00	29.09	24%	19.6	18.8	17.8	3.1	2.9	2.8	15.9	15.8	15.9	3.6	3.8	4.0	5%
CR Power	836 HK	12,768	Buy	21.50	19.34	11%	10.1	9.0	8.1	0.9	0.8	0.8	8.7	9.3	9.9	4.5	5.0	6.2	12%
Longyuan Power	916 HK	14,779	Buy	8.10	5.77	40%	8.5	7.9	6.8	0.5	0.5	0.5	6.4	6.6	7.3	3.5	3.8	4.4	12%
HK Utilities																			
CK Infrastructure	1038 HK	20,113	Buy	82.00	62.60	31%	5.7	17.9	17.6	1.0	1.0	1.0	18.6	5.5	5.5	4.2	4.3	4.3	-43%
HK Electric	2638 HK	7,279	Hold	7.00	6.46	8%	17.3	16.7	16.6	1.1	1.1	1.1	6.7	6.8	6.8	5.0	5.0	5.0	2%
Gas distributors																			
China Gas Holdings	384 HK	4,245	Buy	9.00	6.11	47%	11.4	10.4	9.5	0.6	0.6	0.6	5.0	5.5	5.9	6.1	6.8	7.4	9%
ENN Energy	2688 HK	6,775	Buy	62.00	46.94	32%	7.7	7.6	7.3	0.9	0.9	0.8	12.1	11.6	11.3	6.5	6.6	6.9	3%
China Resources Gas	1193 HK	4,937	Hold	17.00	16.73	2%	11.0	10.9	10.6	0.8	0.8	0.8	7.7	7.6	7.6	5.7	5.7	5.9	2%

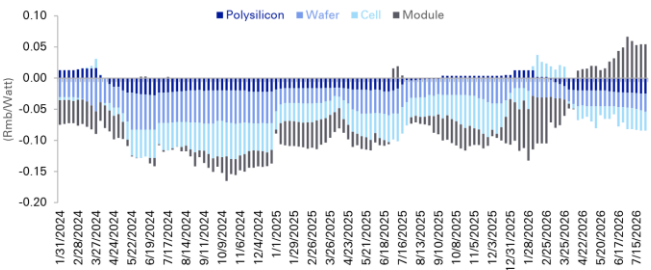
Source: Deutsche Bank estimates (prices as of 31 July, 2026), Bloomberg Finance LP

Figure 6: Solar value-chain spot prices (rebased to 100)



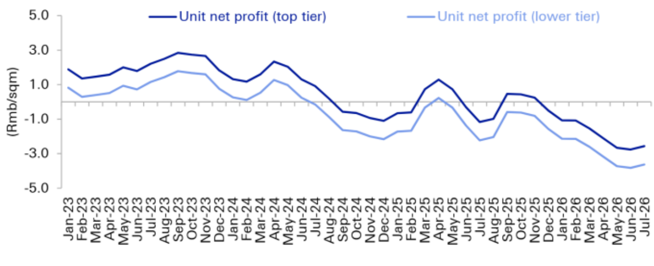
Source: PV InfoLink

Figure 7: Solar components weekly unit net profit tracker



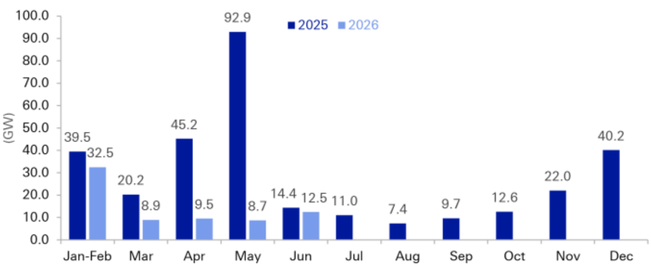
Source: PV InfoLink, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 8: Solar glass margin tracker



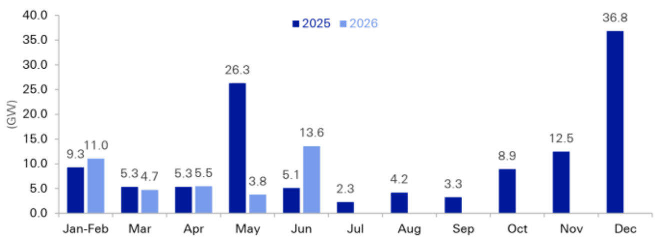
Source: Sci99, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 9: China monthly solar installations



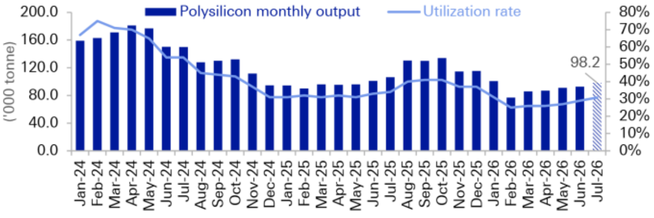
Source: National Energy Administration

Figure 10: China wind monthly installations



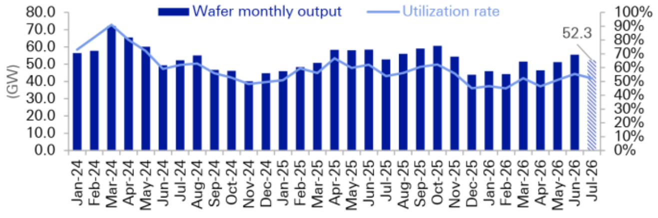
Source: National Energy Administration

Figure 11: Polysilicon – monthly production volume/utilization rate tracker



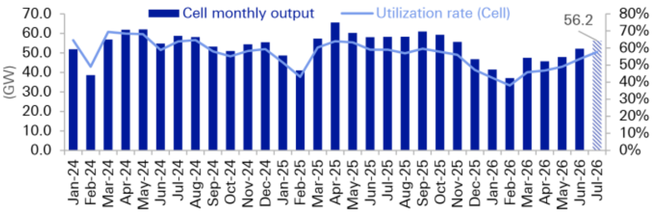
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 12: Wafer – monthly production volume/utilization rate tracker



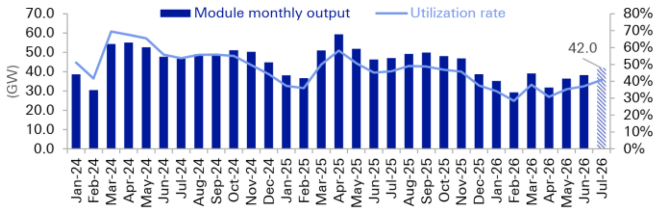
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 13: Cell – monthly production volume/utilization rate tracker



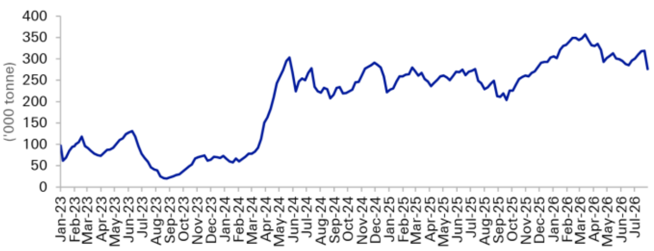
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 14: Module – monthly production volume/utilization rate tracker



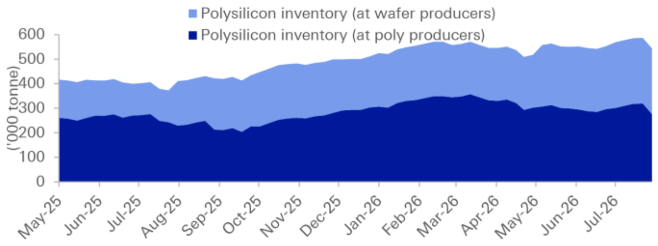
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 15: Polysilicon – weekly inventory (at producers)



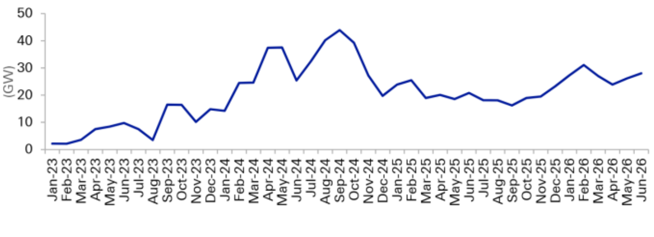
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 16: Polysilicon – weekly total inventory (at both polysilicon and wafer companies)



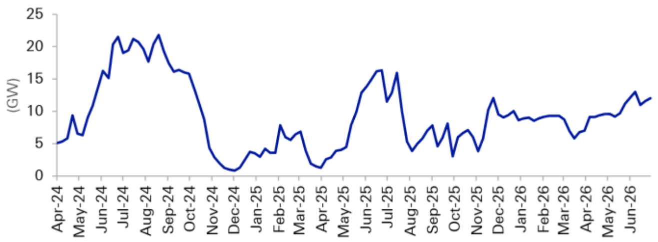
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 17: Wafer – weekly inventory



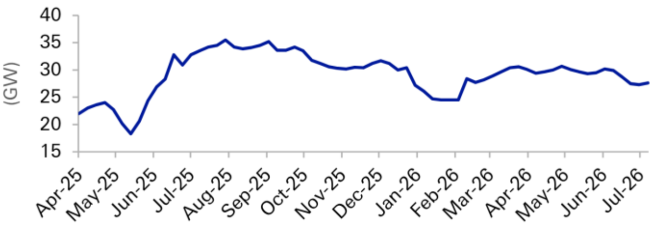
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 18: Cell – weekly inventory



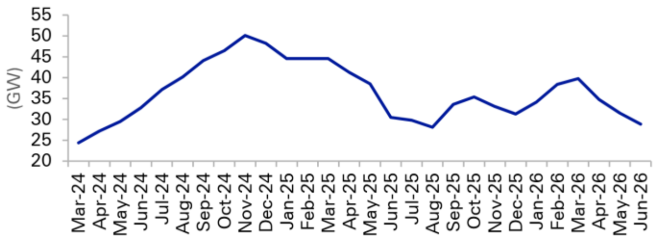
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 19: Module - China weekly inventory



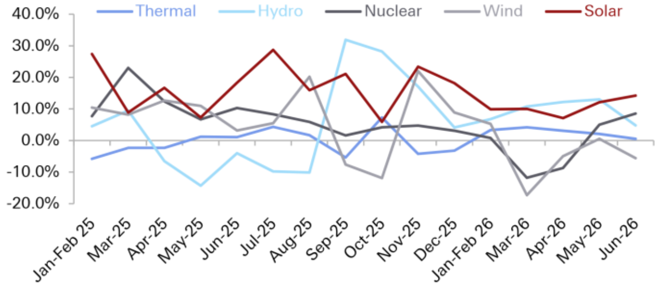
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 20: Module - European monthly inventory



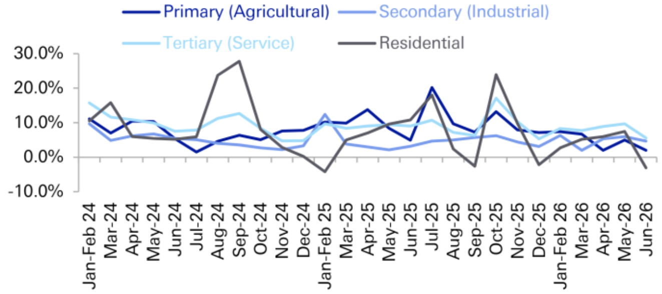
Source: SMM, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 21: China monthly power generation by fuel type (YoY)



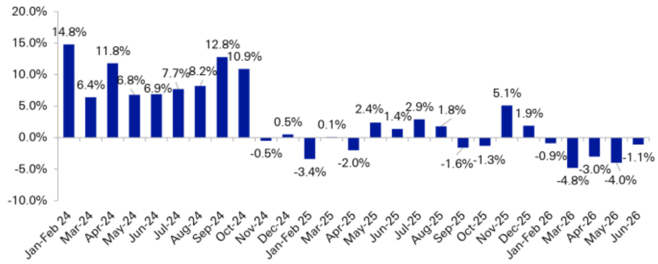
Source: National Bureau of Statistics, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 22: China monthly power consumption by end user (YoY)



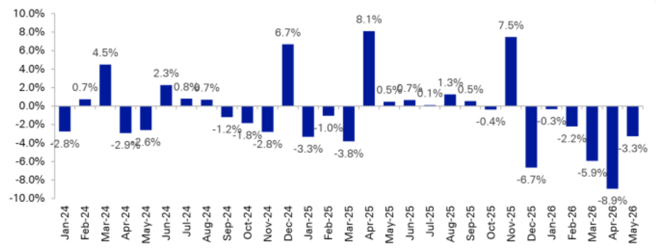
Source: National Energy Administration, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 23: China monthly natural gas demand (YoY)



Source: NDRC, Deutsche Bank estimates

Figure 24: Hong Kong monthly gas demand (YoY)



Source: Census and Statistics Department of Hong Kong, Deutsche Bank estimates

Appendix 1

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DBSI Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	42%	0%
w/ Banking relationship	42%	35%	0%
w/ MiFID services	64%	51%	67%

Global Companies under Coverage	Buy	Hold	Sell
Covered	58%	40%	2%
w/ Banking relationship	46%	32%	32%
w/ MiFID services	76%	69%	94%

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Note - percentages are rounded so may not total 100%.

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w/Banking relation: Percentage of companies under coverage with a rating within each of the "buy", "hold" and "sell" categories for which Deutsche Bank has provided Investment Banking Services within the previous 12 months.

w/MiFID services: Percentage of companies under coverage with a rating within each of the "buy", "hold" and "sell" categories for which Deutsche Bank has provided MIFID Investment and Ancillary services within the previous 12 months.

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